

HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

GOD, IS IT TOO LATE FOR ME?

There is still mercy.

There is still hope.

It's not over.

— LAMENTATIONS 3:22-23



Overcomers
Global Network

EDUCATE . EQUIP . EVOLVE

BY PROPHET JOSHUA MATTHEWS

DEDICATION

This booklet is dedicated to every soul who has looked at their past and wondered if there is still a future. To the one who has made mistakes so deep that you believe even God's grace cannot reach you. You are wrong — and I mean that in the most loving way possible. It is not too late. It was never too late. You are holding the proof in your hands.

A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

Dear friend,

I have sat across from men and women who could barely look me in the eyes because of the weight of their regret. Grown men weeping. Women whispering, "Pastor, if you knew what I've done..." And every single time, the Spirit of the Lord rises up inside me with the same answer: "Tell them it is not too late."

Maybe you've wasted years. Maybe you've broken promises. Maybe you've hurt people you love. Maybe you've done things in the dark that haunt you in the daylight. I am not here to judge you — I am here to tell you that the God who created time is not limited by it. His mercy is new every morning, and morning has come for you.

Read these pages with your heart wide open. Let the Word of God reach into the places where guilt has made its home and let it clean house. There is still a plan for your life, and God is ready to unfold it.

With all my love in Christ,

Joshua Matthews

Founder, Overcomers Global Network

The Cry of the Soul

You know the feeling. It sits in your stomach like a stone. It wakes you up at three in the morning and replays every failure like a movie you cannot turn off.

You see the version of yourself that used to have faith — the one who used to believe that God had great plans for your life — and that person feels like a stranger now. Like someone who existed in a different lifetime.

You look at your age, your circumstances, your track record, and a cold voice inside you says: *"You've used up all your chances. God gave you opportunities and you wasted them. Other people got it right — you didn't. It's over."*

Maybe it's a marriage you destroyed. Maybe it's years spent in addiction. Maybe it's a calling you ignored until the door seemed to close. Maybe it's a sin you committed that you believe crossed a line that cannot be uncrossed.

And so you stopped praying — not because you don't believe in God, but because you believe He's done with you. You go through the motions of life carrying an invisible gravestone on your back that reads: **"Too late."**

But I need to ask you something, and I need you to answer honestly: Who told you that? Was it Scripture? Was it the Holy Spirit? Or was it the enemy of your soul — the accuser of the brethren — who makes his living whispering lies to people God still loves?

""Then I heard a loud voice saying in heaven, 'Now salvation, and strength, and the kingdom of our God, and the power of His Christ have come, for the accuser of our brethren, who accused them before our God day and night, has been cast down.'""

— **Revelation 12:10 (NKJV)**

The accuser has one job: to make you believe you are disqualified from God's love, God's purpose, and God's restoration. And he is very good at his job — because he uses your own memories as weapons against you. He

takes your real failures and paints them in permanent ink, when God writes in mercy.

Here is the truth that will set you free: **God does not operate on your timeline.** He is not checking His watch wondering why you haven't gotten your life together. He is not tallying your failures on a scoreboard. He is a Father — a good Father — and good fathers do not give up on their children.

Think about this: if you had a child who ran away from home, got into trouble, made terrible decisions, and then one day called you crying, "Can I come home?" — would you say, "Sorry, it's too late"? Of course not. You would run to them. You would hold them.

""But when he was still a great way off, his father saw him and had compassion, and ran and fell on his neck and kissed him. And the son said to him, 'Father, I have sinned against heaven and in your sight, and am no longer worthy to be called your son.' But the father said to his servants, 'Bring out the best robe and put it on him, and put a ring on his hand and sandals on his feet. And bring the fatted calf here and kill it, and let us eat and be merry; for this my son was dead and is alive again; he was lost and is found.'""

— Luke 15:20–24 (NKJV)

That father did not say, "Where have you been?" He *ran*. In ancient Middle Eastern culture, a dignified man never ran — it was considered shameful. But this father threw aside his dignity because his love was greater than his reputation. That is how God feels about you.

What the Bible Says

The Bible is not a book of people who got it right on the first try. It is a book of people who failed — spectacularly, repeatedly, painfully — and were still used by God.

Abraham lied about his wife twice to protect himself (Genesis 12:13; 20:2). Yet God called him the father of many nations and made a covenant

with him at 99.

Moses murdered a man and hid the body (Exodus 2:12). He spent 40 years hiding in the desert. Then, at 80 years old, God appeared in a burning bush and said, "I'm sending you to deliver My people."

David committed adultery and arranged a murder (2 Samuel 11). Yet after repentance, God called David "a man after My own heart" (Acts 13:22).

Peter denied Jesus three times on the night of His greatest suffering (Matthew 26:69–75). Yet Jesus restored him and said, "Feed My sheep" (John 21:17). Peter preached at Pentecost and three thousand souls were saved.

Paul hunted Christians and had them imprisoned (Acts 8:3). God chose him to write the majority of the New Testament and bring the Gospel to the world.

Do you see? God does not use perfect people. He restores broken ones.

""And we know that all things work together for good to those who love God, to those who are the called according to His purpose.""

— **Romans 8:28 (NKJV)**

It does not say "all good things." It says *all things* — including the mistakes, the failures, the wasted years.

""So I will restore to you the years that the swarming locust has eaten, the crawling locust, the consuming locust, and the chewing locust, My great army which I sent among you. You shall eat in plenty and be satisfied, and praise the name of the Lord your God, who has dealt wondrously with you; and My people shall never be put to shame.""

— **Joel 2:25–26 (NKJV)**

God will *restore the years*. Not just the future — the years. The time you thought was gone. The seasons you thought were wasted. He specializes in the impossible.

Medical professionals know that the brain has a remarkable ability called neuroplasticity — the capacity to form new connections and literally rewire itself at any age. What science discovers in the natural, God has always known in the spiritual: it is never too late for transformation.

The Root of the Pain

Shame. Shame is different from guilt. Guilt says, "I did something bad." Shame says, "I *am* bad." Guilt can lead to repentance. Shame leads to hiding. Adam and Eve hid from God — not because God changed, but because shame told them they were no longer fit to stand in His presence (Genesis 3:8).

But God went looking for them. "Adam, where are you?" He didn't ask because He didn't know. He asked because He wanted Adam to come out of hiding. God is asking you the same question right now.

Regret. Regret is the mind replaying decisions you cannot undo. Research shows that rumination — repeatedly reviewing past mistakes — activates the brain's stress centers and can lead to depression and learned helplessness. But God is not limited by your past decisions. He is sovereign — He weaves even your worst choices into His plan.

Comparison. You look at other believers — people your age who are walking in their calling, whose marriages are thriving, whose ministries are flourishing — and you think, "That should have been me." Comparison is a thief. It steals your present by measuring it against someone else's highlight reel.

""For we dare not class ourselves or compare ourselves with those who commend themselves. But they, measuring themselves by themselves, and comparing themselves among themselves, are not wise.""

— 2 Corinthians 10:12 (NKJV)

God did not give you someone else's timeline. He gave you yours. And His plans for you are still good:

""For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, says the Lord, thoughts of peace and not of evil, to give you a future and a hope.""

— **Jeremiah 29:11 (NKJV)**

The Fear of Starting Over. Starting over at any age is terrifying. But you are not starting from zero. You are starting with experience, with wisdom, with scars that have made you compassionate, with a hunger for God that casual believers will never understand. Every failure has been training you for what is next.

I have ministered to people in their fifties and sixties who thought their productive years were behind them. And I have watched God open doors for them that young people could not even imagine. Age is not a disqualifier in the Kingdom of God. It never has been. Caleb was 85 years old when he said, "Give me this mountain" (Joshua 14:12). And God gave it to him.

Christ's Healing Power

There is a story in the Gospel of John that I want you to see as if it is happening to you right now.

""Now there is in Jerusalem by the Sheep Gate a pool, which is called in Hebrew, Bethesda, having five porches. In these lay a great multitude of sick people, blind, lame, paralyzed, waiting for the moving of the water... Now a certain man was there who had an infirmity thirty-eight years. When Jesus saw him lying there, and knew that he already had been in that condition a long time, He said to him, 'Do you want to be made well?'"

— **John 5:2-6 (NKJV)**

Thirty-eight years. That man had been lying beside that pool for thirty-eight years waiting for his miracle. Most people had walked past him. Most people had forgotten him. He had probably forgotten himself.

But Jesus did not walk past. Jesus stopped. Jesus looked at him. And Jesus asked him a question that cuts through every excuse, every fear, every

comfort zone: *"Do you want to be made well?"*

I am asking you the same question right now, through the power of the Holy Spirit: Do you want to be made well? Do you want to stop living in the shadow of your past? Do you want to believe — truly believe — that God still has a purpose for your life?

If the answer is yes, then stand up. Spiritually, emotionally, stand up right now. Because Jesus said to that man:

""Rise, take up your bed and walk.""

— John 5:8 (NKJV)

And immediately the man was made well. After thirty-eight years. Immediately. That is the power of one encounter with Christ. One word from God can erase decades of delay.

I want you to understand something about God's economy of time. In the natural, lost time is lost forever. But in the Spirit, God has the ability to compress time, to accelerate destiny, to bring about in months what would have taken years. The prophet Amos saw this:

""Behold, the days are coming,' says the Lord, 'when the plowman shall overtake the reaper, and the treader of grapes him who sows seed; the mountains shall drip with sweet wine, and all the hills shall flow with it.'""

— Amos 9:13 (NKJV)

The plowman overtaking the reaper — that means the harvest comes so fast that by the time you finish gathering, the next planting is already ready. God can do more in one year of obedience than the enemy stole in twenty years of delay.

I have seen this in my own ministry. There were seasons when it felt like nothing was happening — like the seeds I had planted were dying underground. But God was working. He was preparing something I could not see. And when the breakthrough came, it was sudden and it was overwhelming. That is how He works. That is who He is.

The same God is about to do the same thing in your life. The years of the locust are over. The season of silence is breaking. The plans He wrote for you before the foundation of the world are still in His hand, and He is unrolling them right now.

""Your eyes saw my substance, being yet unformed. And in Your book they all were written, the days fashioned for me, when as yet there were none of them.""

— Psalm 139:16 (NKJV)

He wrote your days before you lived them. And He is not scratching anything out.

Healing Prayers

A Prayer to Break the Spirit of "Too Late"

Father, in the name of Jesus Christ, I come against every lie that has told me my time is up. I break the spirit of delay. I break the spirit of regret. I break the spirit of hopelessness. Your Word says You make all things new — not some things, all things (Revelation 21:5). Make me new today. Take every broken piece of my life and rebuild it according to Your design. I receive Your restoration right now. I receive Your timing. I receive Your purpose. It is not too late for me. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer of Repentance and Fresh Start

Lord Jesus, I come to You with everything — the good and the ugly. I repent for the years I wasted. I repent for the opportunities I missed. I repent for the times I chose my own way over Your way. But Lord, I am not asking You to erase my past — I am asking You to redeem it. Use my mess as my message. Use my scars as my testimony. Let the very things the enemy used to shame me become the tools You use to set others free. Give me a fresh start today. Not tomorrow. Today. In Your mighty name, amen.

A Prayer for Accelerated Purpose

Father, I ask You for divine acceleration. Where years have been lost, compress time by Your Spirit. Where doors have been closed, open new ones that no man can shut (Revelation 3:8). Where dreams have died, breathe resurrection life into them again. I believe that my best days are not behind me — they are ahead of me. I partner with You today to walk into everything You have prepared for me. Let it be swift. Let it be undeniable. Let it bring You glory. In Jesus' name, amen.

Prophetic Declarations

Speak these declarations aloud. Let your own ears hear what the Spirit of God is saying over your life:

"It is not too late for me. God's plan for my life is still active."

"The years the enemy stole are being restored right now."

"I am not defined by my past. I am defined by God's promise."

"My age is not a limitation. God uses people at every stage of life."

"Shame has no authority over me. I am covered by the blood of Jesus."

"Today is my Day One. Everything changes from this moment forward."

"God is accelerating my destiny. What should have taken years will happen in months."

"I will fulfill every purpose God assigned to my life."

"My story is not over. The best chapter is being written right now."

"I am chosen, redeemed, forgiven, and still called."

""Forget the former things; do not dwell on the past. See, I am doing a new thing! Now it springs up; do you not perceive it? I am making a way in the wilderness and streams in the wasteland.""

— Isaiah 43:18–19 (NIV)

Reflection & Healing

Sit with these questions. Be honest with yourself and with God. Write your answers in a journal if you can.

Reflect on These Questions

1. What specific failure or regret has been telling you "it's too late"? Name it. Bring it into the light.
2. When you think about that failure, what emotions rise up? Shame? Anger? Grief? Fear? Name those too.
3. If God spoke to you right now about that situation, what do you believe He would say? Write down whatever comes to your heart.
4. Are there people you need to forgive — including yourself — to move forward? What would it take to begin that process?
5. What is one dream, calling, or purpose that you gave up on? Is it possible God is asking you to pick it up again?
6. What is one step — however small — you can take this week to walk toward your future instead of living in your past?

Dear reader, this booklet is a beginning, not an ending. The God who makes all things new is making *you* new — right now, as you sit with these words. Do not be afraid of what comes next. He goes before you.

""The Lord your God, who goes before you, He will fight for you, according to all He did for you in Egypt before your eyes.""

— Deuteronomy 1:30 (NKJV)

It is not too late. Walk forward. He is with you.

A CLOSING PRAYER

Father, I bring before You this precious soul who has carried the lie of "too late" for far too long. In the name of Jesus, I break the power of regret, shame, and hopelessness over their life right now.

Lord, You are the God of new beginnings. You are the God who called Abraham at 75, who used Moses at 80, who restored Peter after his denial. You are the same God today. Do it again, Lord. Give this reader a fresh start. Let today be their Day One.

I decree that their best days are ahead. I decree that what the enemy stole will be returned. I decree that the purpose of God for their life is still active, still alive, and still on schedule. In Jesus' name, amen.

AN INVITATION TO CHRIST

If you have never accepted Jesus Christ as your Lord and Savior — or if you have walked far from Him and want to come home — this is your moment. Pray this prayer: "Lord Jesus, I come to You just as I am. I have sinned. I have failed. But I believe You died for me, You rose again, and Your blood covers every mistake I've ever made. I give You my life — all of it, the broken pieces and the beautiful ones. Forgive me and make me new. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit. I receive You as my Lord today. In Jesus' name, amen."

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GOD, IS IT TOO LATE FOR ME?

Have your mistakes made you feel like you have missed God forever? This booklet speaks hope to the heart weighed down by regret. Through scripture, mercy, and prayer, Joshua Matthews shows that the grace of God still reaches you, and that in Christ it is not too late for a fresh start.

There is still mercy. There is still hope.
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